

Leadership by His Spirit

We have been doing an in-depth study on hearing the voice of God in the Born-Again Trail. In this part of it, we have been studying the inner witness: how the inner witness works.

Today we are going to take it from Romans 2 on through Romans 7 and Romans 8 in the study of hearing His voice.

There are four basic ways He communicates with His children. Foremost is the inner witness. That is the most common one. That is the one every one of us is called to walk by.

I saw something in Brazil, and I told a lady what I saw. Then I told her exactly what was going to happen to her. Sure enough, when I prayed for her, exactly what we said was wrong was wrong, and exactly what we said was going to happen to her happened to her.

When I am ministering, that is not the inner witness. The vision I see is the fourth level of hearing God's voice: vision.

I will be standing there looking at somebody, and a vision will materialize in my spirit. I know it is there. I can see it, but I can also see through it, totally conscious of what is going on around me. That is the most common kind of ministering vision.

Sometimes I will see a heart suspended in front of me, and I will see something, a discoloration. Sometimes I see a bloodstream. It is not hard, when you are looking at something, to explain to people what you see.

So I was able to explain to her what I saw, which was a double curvature, and exactly what was going to happen. When it happened just the way I said it, they asked, "How did you know?"

I said, "It is easy. Can you read a newspaper?"

There are four different ways He communicates, but the first is the inner witness. It is the one we have been looking at.

The second is revelation. I like that one. That is when He capsules a whole revelation on a computer chip, sends it over to your spirit, and then releases the whole revelation at once on the inside of you. Your mind acts as the computer screen. It can only pull up one sentence at a time, yet you have the whole thing in your spirit.

That operates at times when I first meet somebody, or by word of knowledge. I will call somebody out, and suddenly that revelation just goes off in me. I know them like they are an old friend. I can go back and talk about their life just like they are an old friend.

Most of the time, when I meet somebody new for the first time, they may introduce me and I will hear their name, but it will be in the distance because immediately I switch over to the spirit and start monitoring and listening.

Sometimes He will give me a whole scenario. Sometimes your whole life will just come online right then. Most of the time I will not say anything. He does that to give me information, to let me know where you are and what you need.

One of the easiest spirits to pick up is those perverted twins:

"Hi, how are you doing? You are doing fine, are you? You want to take the children's ministry over?"

So He speaks by vision, by revelation, and another way is in the language you communicate in. He will speak words in your spirit. You will hear words in English, or whatever you speak.

When I first started prophesying, He would give me the first sentence to say, and for the first seven years He gave it to me in King James. That is how He would start all the prophecies, and I learned to trust Him.

"Yea, thus saith the Lord."

I learned to trust Him. But if He did not say, "Yea, thus saith the Lord," I knew it was not Him, because that is how He talked. "How art thou?" I knew He talked like that. I saw The Ten Commandments.

Anyway, if He did not use King James, I would not think it was Him. I remember when He broke me from it. When He broke me, He never used King James again, not one time after that, to prophesy through me.

Do you know how He broke me? He said, "How can Chinese prophesy in King James?"

From that day to this, He has not prophesied King James through me. In fact, about the only way He prophesies through me now is through revelation. He drops the mind of Christ in me, and I get to choose my own words. He just wants me to reveal His mind.

But the predominant way He leads every believer, first and foremost, is with the inner witness.

Unfortunately, I would venture to say that three-quarters or more of the Body of Christ is not led by the inner witness.

Why? Because in the inner witness, for the Holy Spirit to bear witness with you that something is drastically wrong or right, there is a part of you He has to use: your conscience.

I am talking about the conscience resident in your born-again human spirit. The Holy Spirit rises up, and the only thing He has to use to bear witness that something is right or wrong is your conscience.

If you have seared yours, if you are walking after money and do not care, if for you to go to church somebody has to pick you up, give you a pillow, and not say one ugly thing or you will quit going, then you have gone against just about everything He has tried to inner-witness to you.

"This is my life. I am going to do with it what I want. I will go to church on Sunday. The rest of the time, leave me alone."

You think when you sear your whole life and say, "I am going to serve myself and go where I want, when I want," that He has something to work with? The only thing He has to use in an inner witness is your conscience.

You have gone against it so many times, not serving God. What part of you do you think He is going to use?

"Well, I have been praying about this and that."

Why? Are you in trouble?

It is like the one guy who sat down to a meal and somebody said, "Did you pray over it?"

He said, "Why? Is there something wrong with it?"

Let us begin again in Romans 2:14.

Paul wrote the Roman church, particularly to a Jewish community there, because Romans 7 says, "I speak to them that know the law." These Jews were having trouble believing that swine-eating Gentiles, who had never kept a day of the law in their lives, could step into the inheritance of Abraham and have God become their Father.

So Paul was explaining to them that the law cannot save you. By the law was the knowledge of sin.

He explains that if a Gentile who never kept the law suddenly gets born again and receives a new nature that empowers him to keep the law by that new nature, does that not become circumcision to him? Is he not saved?

On the other hand, if a Jew who by nature is circumcised cannot keep the law, does that not become uncircumcision to him?

Then Paul lists what a true Jew is. At the end of Romans 2, verses 28 and 29, he says:

"For he is not a Jew,
which is one outwardly;
neither is that circumcision,
which is outward in the flesh:
but he is a Jew,
which is one inwardly;
and circumcision is that of the heart,
in the spirit,
and not in the letter;
whose praise is not of men,
but of God."

Who is the true Jew?

Are you a Jew? Yes. I am a Jew. That is what he said.

The true Jew is not the one who keeps the law by the letter but is unable to keep it. A true Jew is a person who has been born again, for you have inherited the promise to Abraham that in his seed he would inherit the earth.

Hello, Jew. How are you doing?

Backing up, then, you can understand some of these statements:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while accusing
or else excusing one another;
in the day when God shall judge
the secrets of men by Jesus Christ
according to my gospel."

You have to understand that in the standard laid out in those verses is the whole standard by which you are going to stand before Jesus in the judgment day, in front of His seat, for the deeds done in this body, whether good or bad, for your reward.

Here is the whole standard we are judged by. Paul says our conscience bears witness, our thoughts excusing or accusing one another. That is the standard we are going to be judged by.

When you were born again, you received a nature that freed you from sin. Nobody has to preach the Ten Commandments to you anymore. They are written into your nature, into your heart, and into your mind.

Nobody has to come along anymore because your conscience bears witness. Every thought is either excusing or accusing. There is no thought a friend gives you, or that you think of, or that the flesh or the devil brings to you, that your conscience will not either excuse or accuse.

"Well, I did not know adultery was wrong."

You lie. You are lying.

Not because you are a Jew and somebody preached, "Thou shalt not commit adultery."

What happened to the Jew when God told him that while he was spiritually dead? Paul said:

"Is the law sin? God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

A spiritually dead man does not know he is spiritually dead, because that is his nature. He was born that way. How do you know anything is wrong when it is your nature to do it?

Suddenly God comes along with Ten Commandments that you cannot keep anymore and says, "Thou shalt not commit adultery."

You go, "Oh, okay. You mean I cannot have my eight wives and run around with this other one too?"

You thought Abraham was a hero for having a child at a hundred. After Sarah died, he married a woman called Keturah and had five more sons, not counting concubines. He gave them gifts and sent them away to the east because he said they would not inherit with the promise. But he did not stop at a hundred. He was still busy.

Romans 7 is quite a dilemma, because the Jews received the law, acknowledged it with their minds, and said, "The good I would do, I cannot. The evil I do not want to do, that is what I end up doing. So it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me."

What they were saying was, "With my mind I acknowledge the Ten Commandments. I know I am not supposed to do these things, but it is not me doing it. It is something in me."

That is right. It was a sin nature.

But now this Gentile has been born again. Paul says the law has become a law unto himself because it is written in his heart and mind:

"I will be their God,
and they shall be my people:
and their sins and their iniquities
will I remember no more."

No longer will every man say, "Teach your neighbor to know Me," from the least to the greatest. He said, "You shall all know Me," from the least to the greatest, through the new nature that causes Me to write the consciousness of the Ten Commandments into your heart.

Now you have the power to stop.

Your conscience meanwhile bears witness, your thoughts accusing or excusing. Now that I have this new nature, everything that is wrong or immoral, my own conscience either accuses it or excuses it. I do not need any outside source to tell me that any part of the Ten Commandments is wrong or right. That inner witness is all I need.

Unfortunately, that inner witness belongs to your new nature. It is the heart of your conscience. It freed you from sin, but you as a person are not supernatural.

If you stepped out of this body and were walking around, you would still be a person. You would be one person; the Holy Spirit is another. When He baptized you, you were baptized in the Holy Spirit. Now you have access to the One who is supernatural.

This is where He comes in with the inner witness.

You have a conscience inside that knows right from wrong. But a lot of you just walk the way you want anyway, so you killed it. You seared it. It is just a weak little voice way down in there, eventually dying out if you are not careful. You can lose that altogether. If there is nothing in you at all that wants to serve God, you probably need to get saved again.

Hallelujah.

My human spirit is one spirit. The Holy Spirit is another. I have a conscience inside that knows right from wrong. But if wrong or evil happens to be masked in good, such as Hebrews says:

"Strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age,
even those who by reason of use
have their senses exercised
to discern both good and evil,"

then sometimes you think you discern evil because some man comes along and starts the same patterns the last guy did to you. You see those patterns develop and say, "I can tell how this is going to come out." You think you are supernaturally discerning. You are not.

I do not have the ability to reach outside of myself in my own human spirit and discern. That is why He gave me the Holy Ghost.

Sometimes evil is cloaked in good, and it looks absolutely perfect. I am standing there going, "This is really going to do good," because I cannot see the evil that is hidden. In my own spirit I do not have supernatural powers that know everything.

All I know is that if you present something to me and it is immoral, I know I am not supposed to do it. But I cannot tell outside of that. If you unmask it and show it to me, then I can judge whether it is moral, and I will not do it.

This is where the Holy Spirit comes in. Unfortunately, the only thing He has to use to bear witness with you is the conscience you already have.

So if you have burned it, walked your own way, and served yourself, this is why many believers are not led by the Holy Spirit in the first level, the inner witness. You have walked wrong, sinned, and violated so much that He has nothing to work with to bear witness that something is wrong. You have seared and killed the part He needs.

"I am going to serve myself."

Go ahead. You will not have the leadership of the Spirit running in your direction, running against your conscience trying to make a godly man or woman out of you.

We serve ourselves, go our own direction, and do not care. Then we pop up and say, "I have really been praying about whether I should do this."

Why would God care whether you do it? You have served yourself up until now.

"I am praying whether I should move to this other city."

Why would He care? You have done nothing in this one.

Particularly in relationships, listen.

Women, you can get a man to put his whole leadership system aside just by using his ego system. Of course, we can get you to lay yours aside with a little flattery. It is usually your mama who steps in and knows the difference:

"Do not do it, child. You will have six kids and end up living with me."

"But I love him, Mom. I love him."

Too bad you cannot market that.

One time I preached at the Big City Singles. They asked me to teach. For God's sake, I do not know why. I had to get there at 6:30 to eat, and then there was a little message at 7:00. By 6:30, everybody looked like they had stepped just out of a fashion window. They really looked good at 6:30 for breakfast and a singles meeting. Would you believe that?

It was not just orneriness on my part that caused me to take the text. It was not just me only. There was that part of me He could use.

I preached from 1 Corinthians:

"Art thou loosed from a wife?
seek not a wife.
Art thou bound unto a wife?
seek not to be loosed."

That is what I preached on. It had been a long time since I had been in a meeting that quiet.

That is one of the biggest fatalities, generally, of men and women. How do you think men operate, especially around the second marriage or so? Second, third, maybe?

When they come into the room, their lips go in there a full minute before they do. They know all the right things to say. They look like Mr. Perfect. Here is evil cloaked in good, but you do not know the difference.

"He is just so right."

All the time, because you do have a conscience the Holy Spirit can use, and because instead of seeking a husband, like He said not to do, you have been seeking God with all your heart and He is sending you on with your conscience intact, the Holy Spirit can use it.

When he comes in and suddenly his lips are this far out ahead of him, something inside is going, "No, no."

He says, "I have never seen anybody so beautiful."

You say, "Shut up in there. Shut up."

"You are just so beautiful. I will make a princess out of you."

"No. Shut up. I will fast and pray and change him."

Let me tell you, sweetie, if you do not have the power to fast and pray until the right one comes, you will not have the power to do so when the wrong one is slapping you around with three kids and you are supporting the family.

The first level of the inner witness is supernatural. He knows the end of one situation from another, and He is always there to bear witness inside, always, whether good or bad. He knows all the evil that is cloaked. He is there to guide you with such precision that it would shock you.

In your business deals, He is usually the first thing to go off:

"Bad deal. Bad deal."

Everything looks perfect on paper, absolutely perfect, but inside your conscience is bothered.

"There is something wrong with this." That is the Holy Spirit having a fit in your conscience.

Then you will look at some desert road, and there is nothing down it. He says, "Go down it."

"There is nothing down there."

"Go."

"No. Why can I not take the one with the river?"

"I need you to go down this road."

"There is no logical reason."

That is right. But that leadership of the Spirit is available.

This will be the system again that you and I will be judged by when we stand before Him on that day of reward and He burns all the trash.

You say, "I did not know that was wrong."

He says, "You did."

"I did not get that out of my life because I did not know."

He says, "You did."

In fact, you will not be able to stand before Him on that judgment day without being accountable for every part of your life that you threw away.

It will be the last judgment. He will burn the trash. You will scream and cry, and whatever you have left, you will go into His peace forever and ever.

Hallelujah.

If a person hardens his conscience, it is very hard to be led by the Holy Spirit, because that conscience is the only part in you that He has to bear witness with.

Get accustomed to walking with that, and revelation will become common. Those visions will become common. Then you will hear Him literally say words in English, or the language you speak, inside. That will become common.

I love those ministering visions. I found out that He will use them more, even when I am witnessing to sinners. He uses them as much, or more, as in the service.

When I go after a sinner, God gets the whole arsenal out: workings of miracles, gifts of healings, you name it. The whole arsenal arms itself when I go after a sinner.

I remember when He was first teaching me about hearing His voice and visions. We were having a meeting eighteen miles away, and I worked in a mill in Oregon. He told me to go invite this man to the meeting. Then I had one of those visions and heard a voice say, "Since he is going to La Pine tonight, just invite him to the meeting."

I could see him in a car. I was afraid to go ask him, but finally I got brave enough and said, "Sir, since you are already going to La Pine tonight, why do you not come to the meeting we are having there?"

He said, "I am not going."

I said, "Oh. Okay. I just wanted to invite you."

So I wandered off, but I could not take it anymore. I finally came back and said, "Why were you going to La Pine?"

He said, "Oh, I had to pick up a load of stuff."

Glory to God. I knew it. I knew it. It made me happy.

One time I was working on my car, and two Jehovah's Witnesses came up to me. I was listening to them while tightening a bolt down.

"The kingdom is coming. We live in a Watchtower..."

You have to remember, the one doing the talking is the one in training. The other one is standing by to step in at any moment if they get into trouble.

By the time I was done with them, they were arguing with each other. I had one of those visions. The younger girl talking to me looked very distraught, and in the vision, by revelation, I knew what it was all about.

I said, "You are having serious doubts over this belief. In fact, you have been back and forth. You are not sure what you got yourself into. I can tell you, you got yourself into a false religion, and God is trying to get to you."

Her eyes got real big. The older one turned on her and said, "Is that true?"

I just went back to working on my car.

After moving to Oregon, I was isolated for three months in a place with no church and nothing. I would go out and sit in my car and bootleg a wild renegade station out of old Mexico, trying to get David Terrell. I had to be to work at 6:00, but I would be out there at 2:00 in the morning: "You are going to die."

Then two Jehovah's Witnesses knocked on the door. I had had no fellowship for months. They said, "May we come in and talk to you about God?"

I said, "Oh yes," said the spider to the fly. "Come into my lair."

They came in. By the time I was done, about twenty minutes later, they had run out the door, jumped in their car, started the engine, and were trying to back out of our driveway. He was trying to back up and roll the window up at the same time.

I said, "I am not done."

I was chasing the car, trying to finish through the window. "I am trying to tell you about speaking in tongues and miracles. You are not listening."

Hallelujah.

Paul is explaining how the Gentile can be saved. Suddenly they receive a nature that empowers them to keep the law, whereas the Jew, who by nature and law had been circumcised, still has an old nature and cannot keep the law.

If these Gentiles can keep it, does that not become circumcision to them? A true Jew is the Jew who inherited Abraham's blessing and is able now to keep the law, not by animal sacrifice, but by a new nature that has freed him from sin.

That is the wind-up in Romans 2:28-29:

"For he is not a Jew,
which is one outwardly;
neither is that circumcision,
which is outward in the flesh:
but he is a Jew,
which is one inwardly;
and circumcision is that of the heart,
in the spirit,
and not in the letter;
whose praise is not of men,
but of God."

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Now let us go over to Romans 8. Let me give you the first verse:

"There is therefore now no condemnation
to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh,
but after the Spirit."

I need to put this terminology into your mind. When he says, "who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit," most of you who have followed this for the last couple of years can tell me what I am talking about.

When he talks about walking after the flesh, he is talking about a spiritually dead man, a Jew in particular, who received the law and could not keep it because he was spiritually dead. That is the walk after the flesh he is talking about here.

He says, "but after the Spirit."

"Well, truly that is talking about walking after the Holy Spirit."

No, not in this direct quote. He is talking about walking after the born-again nature he has received, that has freed him from sin.

So when he says there is no condemnation to those in Christ Jesus who walk not after the flesh but after the born-again new nature of their spirit, what kind of condemnation is he talking about?

The condemnation he is talking about here is the condemnation of a spiritually dead Jew who received the law and could not keep it. He said, "The good I would do, I cannot. The evil I have been refusing to do, that is what I end up doing. So it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me, because with my mind I am trying to keep the Ten Commandments, but I cannot keep them because I have a death nature."

When he says there is therefore now no condemnation, it means there are no more condemning sentences. A spiritually dead man had received commandments by God but could not keep them, so he was condemned to death by them. That is the kind of condemnation he is talking about.

There is therefore now no condemnation, no more condemning sentences, to the Jew who was spiritually dead, received the Ten Commandments, and could not keep them.

Why? We have been freed. We have been born again, and now we walk after the spirit. That new nature has freed us from the condemnation, or the condemning sentence, that sentenced us and forced us to sin because we were spiritually dead.

Can you prove that?

Yes, but I wish I did not have to back up to Romans 7 for just a minute. Look at Romans 7:5:

"For when we were in the flesh,
the motions of sins,
which were by the law,
did work in our members
to bring forth fruit unto death."

Paul is speaking hypothetically, putting himself in the position of every Jew who received the law and could not keep it. I did not say they did not have animal sacrifice and live with the law. I am saying they did not have a nature that freed them from sin. They could not keep the law by being free from a nature that forced them into sin.

When we were in the flesh, the motions of sins, or sins on the move, which were by the law, worked in our members to bring forth fruit unto the spiritual death we lived in.

Here we were, spiritually dead. All of a sudden, here comes this commandment that says, "Thou shalt not commit adultery." We tried to stop, but we could not. That law set sin into motion because He told us to quit, and we could not, even though we tried. Spiritual death bore fruit through the law, and they ended up sinning.

Look at it again. When we were in the flesh, sin on the move, which was by the law because He told us to quit sinning and we could not, worked in our members and bore a whole lot of fruit to the spiritual death we had already been made by the fall of Adam.

But verse 6 shows your deliverance:

"But now we are delivered from the law,
that being dead wherein we were held;
that we should serve in newness of spirit,
and not in the oldness of the letter."

What part of me is dead that the law had a hold on? My old man, my old nature, the old man of sin. He is the one who sinned. He is the one the law had a hold of.

All of a sudden, he is gone. He is dead. A new man has replaced him. I have become free from the law.

I get so excited I want to preach the next forty-five minutes on it.

We are delivered from the law because the law had a hold of my old man, and that old man is dead. The old man passed away. The law had a hold of him because he had a sin nature. Now I am free because he is dead. The law has nothing to hold on to.

So now we serve in newness of spirit, out of that new nature, and not in the oldness of the letter.

Who is the man who walks after the flesh? He is the spiritually dead man who received the law and could not keep it, so it bore fruit unto sin because he had a death nature.

But we have been freed. Romans 8:1 dictates that freedom when it says there is therefore no more of these kinds of condemning sentences that can be carried out in us, because we no longer walk after the flesh. We have the newness of spirit. We have been born again and have a nature that has freed us from sin.

Now you can understand what spirit he is talking about in Romans 8:2:

"For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus
hath made me free
from the law of sin and death."

What is the Spirit of life?

Notice here, King James has a capital "S." Naughty, naughty, naughty. That is not a capital "S." He is talking about your human spirit.

You have to understand that the word for spirit was the same. By the merit of translation, how the word was used in the context of the verse is how they tried to figure out whether it was talking about the Holy Spirit or the human spirit. Here they put that it was the Holy Spirit, when in reality it was your human spirit.

Until I understood that, there was a lot of bondage in my life. Now I am so free I cannot stand myself, much less ask you to.

Hallelujah.

For the law of the Spirit of life: what is the Spirit of life he is talking about? It was in Christ Jesus and made me free from another law, the law of sin and death.

What Spirit of life is he talking about? I can tell you. He is talking about your born-again human spirit. The law that emanates from the Spirit of life He gave you is a new nature. That Spirit of life is my born-again human spirit.

It was once in Christ. For as the Father had life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself, and the Son gave to me to have life within myself.

Now the law that emanates from the Spirit of life, or that born-again human spirit He gave me, has set me free from sin.

How? It freed me from the law that emanated from the death nature I had before I was born again.

There is only one way to free me from the death nature that emanated from the spiritual death that was once in my spirit: replace it with another law. The law of the Spirit of life, which is the new nature that emanates from my born-again spirit, cancels the other one.

The way to free us from sin is to replace the nature that sinned. The law of the Spirit of life, or the law that emanates from my born-again spirit, is a new nature that was once in Christ Jesus and is now in me. It has freed me from the other law that emanated from the death nature I once had, which was sin.

Hallelujah. I have been made free.

This starts getting interesting. Romans 8:3 says:

"For what the law could not do,
in that it was weak through the flesh,
God sending his own Son
in the likeness of sinful flesh,
and for sin,
condemned sin in the flesh."

What the law could not do, because it was weak through the flesh, through the operation of that old nature in your flesh against your mind, God did. They gave them the Ten Commandments, but they could not keep them.

God sent His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, or by a sacrifice for sin, and condemned sin in the flesh. It received a condemning sentence. He condemned it.

It does not have the power to operate in me anymore because He killed the power plant. I have a new nature. I do not have the old. He condemned all sin in the flesh.

"Do I have to sin?"

No, you do not.

He condemned sin in the flesh with that new nature. There is nothing the devil or anybody else has to lay hold of now to force you into sin, because the law that emanates from the Spirit of life you received in Christ Jesus is a new nature and condemned all sin in your life and in your flesh.

"The devil made me do it."

The devil made you do nothing. He condemned sin in the flesh.

Sickness and disease are a result of the fall. If He condemned sin, He condemned all the results of it. Poverty, where you cannot do a thing for the kingdom, is also tied to the fall.

Do you know why some of your prosperity does not work? Because you are trying to make yourself rich instead of the kingdom. That is why it does not work.

"I gave and I gave and I gave, and it just does not work."

He condemned sin and all its friends. Everything that had its root in the fall has received a death sentence. It has been condemned, and I am just stubborn enough to walk it out.

I finally found out what the blessings of Abraham were. God finally told me what they were, and He told me how to qualify.

Just a couple of months ago, something happened to me. When I came out of it, He said, "Son, you are qualifying now. You are just beginning to qualify to walk like Abraham did."

Glory be to God.

I know about this stuff. It took Him ten years to kill greed, love of money, and false operation in me. When He finally got me good and dead, He said, "Now you are starting to walk like Abraham, just a little bit."

That means a whole lot of blessings for other people, because I can bless them from adding themselves to you, because you are going to walk with Me.

It made me so happy when He said that.

I had not even been able to hand the envelope out for eight or nine years. We bought a million-dollar piece of property here, and I could not hand out one envelope. I could not say anything. I just had to stand there.

He said, "You are going to have to learn how to believe Me."

All that junk has been condemned. I have a new nature, and I am finding out how to walk it out now. I could not hand envelopes out. I could not do anything. I could just stand there and believe God.

Sometimes the ground would just shake. We had a \$27,000 payment due on the building every three months, and besides that about a \$10,000-a-month payment on the building. I would come in off the road and have to believe in about \$40,000 every three months. I could not tell the crowd. I could not tell anybody anything. My ground was shaking.

After the first two or three years in the ministry, I always drove a new car. Then, because I could not ask for anything, I was driving those old cars with 250,000 miles on them. I was afraid the wheels were going to buckle out at a stop sign.

I remember a few years ago when I was believing God for a new car. Nothing. Thank God my Audi was locked in second. I could get up and down the hill. Everything kept shaking. It shook right down to about three cornstalks in my little field.

You should have seen me out in my little field, holding on to my cornstalks. "They are mine. I believed them in. The devil cannot take them because he did not give them to me. They are my cornstalks."

When I start sowing these little three or four ears of corn, it will be mine.

Anyway, I guess I can tell you what He shook me down to. He said, "You have to learn how to believe Me. As long as you depend on anything besides Me, like a big fat mailing list and a bunch of people to beg money out of so you can get some project done..."

He said, "I have a divine order. It is My will for them to get involved. But if nobody gets involved, if they cannot or they quit, do you think that in eternity, where we wrote down that He does not have to do this now, whether you are involved or not makes any difference to God?"

This is where He had to get me to.

He said, "I only need one thing from you, son. I need the authority that you operate in. When heaven has that, I can send you to outer Mongolia, and those people will eat. You can feed them, clothe them, get them all healed, and then train them how to serve Me. All I need anywhere is the authority that emanates from your spirit. I can give the rest of those people everything. But if you cannot go because you do not have a mailing list to tap, I cannot use you."

Evidently, I graduated a little bit in something.

I had something in my body that had appeared, and it was fighting me like a crazy man. The longer I stood, the worse it hurt. I went to India and prayed hands on thousands of people, and I felt like my whole side was falling off. I was almost dragging my leg.

Just a couple of months ago, after January when we do our annual, I had spent so many days fasting and praying in my sound booth. Then the Lord gave me some instructions and said, "There is no use going any further until you rectify this, this, and this."

I said, "Yes, sir."

I jumped up out of the closet and went out and started doing what He said. I noticed that every trace of that thing just went. It was gone.

He said to me, "The same authority, son, that condemned that in your body has just condemned the rest of that operation, the way you used to operate. Now, son, you know who Abraham is. You have freed Me to begin to bless you like Abraham."

I went, and I can hear Him too.

Do we have some blessings heading our way. But remember where the authority comes from and what you need to major on, because God only has one thing to use to set you free.

You may think He has two. No, He has just one. He only has one thing to use to set you free, and that is in Romans 8:11.

Romans 8:11 says:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead
shall also quicken your mortal bodies
by his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

In the light of that verse, I can tell you this: the first time Paul mentions the Holy Spirit in Romans 8 is verse 16:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness
with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

There they have the "S" letters in the right place. That is the first time he mentions the Holy Spirit.

So I am going to tell you right now about this victory walk. When I went into the spirit two and a half years ago and saw the Born-Again Trail in front of me, I have been teaching on it ever since. I thought it would be a four- or five-month teaching and then stop.

It is the gospel. It is the gospel. It has not ended. I am so shocked.

Only now am I coming to the fullness of understanding what He was trying to say, to the degree where that power rises up and condemns things in my body and condemns things in our operation.

When He said, "If the Spirit of Him that raised Christ from the dead dwell in you," for the sake of teaching, that is your born-again spirit. If the Spirit of Him, the one that is of God, dwells in you, your born-again spirit, the one that raised Jesus, the new nature that quickened Him from death to life, if that one dwells in you, then He, the Father, will quicken, make alive, and bring life to your mortal bodies by His Spirit that dwells in you.

"The Holy Spirit?"

No. If your spirit says no, there is not much the Holy Ghost can do. Most believers have Him locked up anyway.

The Father will use the entire corporate structure of heaven to quicken your mortal bodies, but the only power He has as a resource, whether He can do something for you or not, is by His Spirit that dwells in you.

If He is unable to operate in this life with victory in you, it is because God cannot use your human spirit to bring your victory. You are weak. You follow other things. You do not nourish it. You do not feed it.

Your spirit is the only medium He has to use. By His Spirit that dwells in you is where He brings the life. There is no other source.

When your spirit begins to flow with God, that is when the Holy Ghost can kick in and add His power. Not before. After. The Father will bring life by His Spirit, the spirit you have been born again with. He has nothing else to use.

Listen real closely:

"You cannot get healing for the body as far as you are personally concerned. Somebody else's faith may, but until your spirit is right, you cannot get healing for your body."

John G. Lake said that. I do not know who told him this stuff. I do not think our tapes were around then.

He also said:

"May I call your attention to another thing? Faith is a product of your spirit, not of your intellect. Your intellect does not produce faith. Your knowledge may give you ground for faith, but faith is resident in your spirit."

Joy is something in your spirit. Happiness is something connected with your surroundings.

This is how I used to say it: joy is a fruit of the Spirit, and happiness is a fruit of joy. You may lock me up in jail, and I will have joy, but I will not be happy about it.

Look at how he said it. He is saying the same thing. I do not know who taught him this. Our book was not around.

Joy is something in your spirit. Happiness is something connected with your surroundings. You are happy because of your surroundings. You are joyful because you are in right relationship with the Father.

Faith, love, joy, and hope all spring from your spirit, being the hidden man of the heart. They are all products of your spiritual life.

The reason people do not have rich, beautiful faith is because their spirit is denied the privilege of communion and fellowship with the Father.

Do you understand me? You do not read your Bible. You do not pore over it. You do not live in it. You do not spend time in fellowship with the Father. Consequently, your spirit is depleted and weakened. Faith springs out of it, and the faith that grows out of it is a sickly plant.

For if the Spirit of Him dwells in you, the born-again spirit, then He, the Father, will quicken and bring life to every area of your mortal body and your existence.

He will quicken your mortal bodies by what medium? By His Spirit that dwells in you.

Do you have a sickly plant?

This is why, in God's infinite wisdom, He bypassed your intellect, your soul, how smart you are, and how spiritual you are. He baptized you in the Holy Ghost, bypassed all of it, and then gave you a language all the way from heaven to pray, leaving your intellect out of it, just so you would have some kind of chance.

He bypassed everything, went right for the power plant, and began to change you. He said, "All you have to do is pray in tongues, and the whole thing will begin."

You have that right. He will start building you up in the part of you where real authority and real faith live.